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Z

zeal

When someone is **zealous**, that person is passionately devoted to someone or something. The zealous person values that thing or person's reputation and honor. The zealous person will be angry if anyone dishonors the thing or person the zealous person values. The zealous person will defend the honor of the thing or person they value.

A person can be zealous for their own self. For example, the Creator God will zealously defend his own honor and show that God is who God says he is.

A person can be zealous for another person. The zealous person values that other person and wants to protect the relationship to stay completely devoted to one another.

A person can also be zealous for a cause or a way of life that the person cares deeply about. The zealous person will work hard for the cause or to follow that way of life and often will try to convince others to feel the same way.

Sometimes, zeal can also refer to the actions that show that a person is zealous for something or someone. For example, in the story of Jehu in 2 Kings, Jehu tells another person to come see Jehu's zeal for God. Jehu means that the other person should watch Jehu's actions because Jehu's actions will show how zealous Jehu feels for God.

zeal

Audio Content
mp3 file (806 KB)

Zion

People sometimes used **Zion** as another name for the city of Jerusalem. Zion was the name of one of the mountains in the city of Jerusalem, where the people called the Jebusites lived before King David conquered the city. When King David conquered the city, people called the city either "the city of David," or "Zion." Later, people used Zion as a name for the whole city of Jerusalem. Many writers in the Bible use the name Zion especially when they are talking about Jerusalem as a holy place where God lives with his people.

Zion

Audio Content
mp3 file (495 KB)